

Serialization et Deserialization



Java built-in serialization — Serializable interface

```
1 // Step 1 - implement Serializable (marker interface)
2 import java.io.Serializable;
3
4 class User implements Serializable {
5     private static final long serialVersionUID = 1L; // version stamp
6     private String name;
7     private int age;
8
9     User(String name, int age) {
10         this.name = name;
11         this.age = age;
12     }
13 }
14
15 // Step 2 - SERIALIZE: object → file
16 User user = new User("Ali", 30);
17
18 try (ObjectOutputStream oos =
19     new ObjectOutputStream(
20         new FileOutputStream("user.ser"))) {
21     oos.writeObject(user); // packed into bytes → file
22 }
23
24 // Step 3 - DESERIALIZE: file → object
25 try (ObjectInputStream ois =
26     new ObjectInputStream(
27         new FileInputStream("user.ser"))) {
28     User loaded = (User) ois.readObject(); // bytes → object back
29     System.out.println(loaded.name); // "Ali"
30 }
```

Excluding fields — the transient keyword

Some fields should NOT be serialized: passwords, connections, Optional fields, computed values.

```
1 class User implements Serializable {
2     private static final long serialVersionUID = 1L;
3 }
```

```

4     String name;
5     transient String password; // excluded - security
6     transient Optional<String> email; // excluded - not Serializable!
7     transient Connection db; // excluded - makes no sense
8 }
9
10 User user = new User();
11 user.name = "Ali";
12 user.password = "secret123";
13
14 // After serialize → deserialize:
15 loaded.name → "Ali" // saved
16 loaded.password → null // transient: wiped
17 loaded.email → null // transient: wiped

```

i This is exactly why `Optional` cannot be a field — `Optional` does not implement `Serializable`. Mark it `transient` or use a nullable field instead.

Serialization = Java emballe TOUS les champs dans des bytes.

```

1 class User implements Serializable {
2     String name; // String → Serializable Java sait
    emballer
3     int age; // int → Serializable Java sait
    emballer
4     Optional<String> email; // Optional → ??? Java ne sait pas
    emballer
5 }
6
7 // Ce code plante à l'exécution :
8 User user = new User("Ali", 30, Optional.of("ali@gmail.com"));
9 new ObjectOutputStream(...).writeObject(user); //
    NotSerializableException: Optional

```

La solution — séparer le stockage de l'accès :

```

1 class User implements Serializable {
2
3     String name;
4     int age;
5     String email; // champ nullable - Java sait l'emballer
6
7     // Optional UNIQUEMENT dans le getter - jamais stocké
8     Optional<String> getEmail() {
9         return Optional.ofNullable(email); // créé à la volée
10    }
11 }

```

Java built-in serialization is rare — JSON is what you use daily

REST APIs, Spring Boot, microservices → everything is JSON serialization via Jackson.

```

1 // Jackson dependency (Maven / Spring Boot already includes it)
2 // <dependency> com.fasterxml.jackson.core:jackson-databind
    </dependency>
3
4 import com.fasterxml.jackson.databind.ObjectMapper;
5
6 class User {
7     public String name;
8     public int age;

```

```

9     User() {} // Jackson needs no-arg
    constructor
10     User(String n, int a) { name=n; age=a; }
11 }
12
13 ObjectMapper mapper = new ObjectMapper();
14
15 // SERIALIZE: object → JSON string
16 User user = new User("Ali", 30);
17 String json = mapper.writeValueAsString(user);
18 // → {"name":"Ali","age":30}
19
20 // DESERIALIZE: JSON string → object
21 User loaded = mapper.readValue(json, User.class);
22 // → User("Ali", 30)
23
24 // File ↔ object
25 mapper.writeValue(new File("user.json"), user);
26 User fromFile = mapper.readValue(new File("user.json"), User.class);

```

Jackson annotations — what you'll use in Spring Boot daily

```

1 import com.fasterxml.jackson.annotation.*;
2
3 class User {
4     // rename field in JSON
5     @JsonProperty("full_name")
6     public String name;
7
8     // exclude from JSON output
9     @JsonIgnore
10    public String password;
11
12    // include only when not null
13    @JsonInclude(JsonInclude.Include.NON_NULL)
14    public String email;
15
16    // format dates
17    @JsonFormat(pattern = "dd/MM/yyyy")
18    public LocalDate birthDate;
19 }
20
21 // Result:
22 // { "full_name": "Ali", "birthDate": "01/01/1994" }
23 // password → gone (JsonIgnore)
24 // email → gone (null + NON_NULL)

```

In Spring Boot — serialization is automatic

```

1 // You write this:
2 @RestController
3 class UserController {
4
5     @GetMapping("/user/{id}")
6     User getUser(@PathVariable int id) {
7         return new User("Ali", 30); // return object
8     } // Spring serializes → JSON
9
10    @PostMapping("/user")
11    User createUser(@RequestBody User user) { // JSON → object
12        return userService.save(user); // auto deserialized
13    }
14 }
15

```

```
16 // HTTP GET /user/1 → {"name":"Ali","age":30}
17 // HTTP POST /user ← {"name":"Sara","age":25}
```

- i** Spring Boot uses Jackson automatically — you never call `ObjectMapper` manually in controllers.

JAVA BUILT-IN	JSON / REAL WORLD
<code>implement Serializable</code>	<code>Jackson = most used library</code>
<code>objectOutputStream → write</code>	<code>writeValueAsString → serialize</code>
<code>objectInputStream → read</code>	<code>readValue → deserialize</code>
<code>transient → exclude field</code>	<code>@JsonIgnore → exclude</code>
<code>serialVersionUID → version</code>	<code>@JsonProperty → rename</code>
WHY OPTIONAL BREAKS IT	SPRING BOOT
<code>Optional not Serializable</code>	<code>Jackson auto-wired</code>
<code>use nullable field + Optional getter</code>	<code>@RequestBody → deserialize</code>
	<code>return object → serialize</code>